

THEME

The case of Lado Kumari highlights the transformative power of a supportive educational environment in shaping a child's future. Born into an economically challenged family with limited educational background, Lado initially showed little interest in learning due to the poor condition of her Anganwadi center. However, after the center was renovated using BALA (Building as Learning Aid) techniques, bright paintings, learning materials, and child-friendly spaces, Lado's interest in education was awakened. Regular attendance, combined with engaging teaching tools, helped her learn foundational skills in English, Hindi, and mathematics. Her intellectual growth reflects how even a child from a marginalized background can flourish when given access to quality early childhood education. The active involvement of her mother, who began to understand the value of education through community meetings, played a crucial role in Lado's progress. Today, Lado is enrolled in a middle school, symbolizing a hopeful journey from neglect to empowerment through education.

TITLE

“HOPE IN RAJI SAHBAZPUR:LADO’S LEAP
TOWARD LEARNING”

ORGANIZATION

CRY(CHILD RIGHTS AND YOU) BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT LADO KUMARI

- AGE-Approximately 6 years old
- SEX-Female
- COMMUNITY-Backward Class

- MOTHER-Neha Devi
- FATHER-Pintu Rai

HER ACCESS TO SCHOOL

- Lado Kumari now attends the Upgraded Middle School, Raji Sahbazpur, which is located about 2 kilometers from her village. She travels to school daily by walking, as the distance is manageable on foot. Before enrolling in this school, Lado had limited access to quality education due to the poor condition of her local Anganwadi center. However, after improvements at the center, her learning interest increased, motivating her parents to enroll her in formal schooling. The nearby school provides a better environment for her studies,

helping her continue her educational journey despite her family's economic challenges and lack of transportation facilities.

ABOUT HER FAMILY

- Lado Kumari's family consists of five members—her father, mother, two younger brothers, and one sister, with Lado being the eldest child. The family's economic condition is modest, owning only the land on which their house is built, without any agricultural land for farming. The primary source of livelihood is from Lado's father, Pintu Rai, who earns money by driving a rented tempo (autorickshaw). Her mother, Neha Devi, is a homemaker and does not engage in any income-generating activities. The family relies solely on Pintu Rai's earnings for their daily needs. Despite their

financial constraints and lack of formal education, the family supports Lado's education and well-being, showing hope for better opportunities in the future.

BACKGROUND

- Lado Kumari comes from a modest and economically disadvantaged family belonging to a socially and educationally backward class. Her father, Pintu Rai, is illiterate and works as a tempo (auto-rickshaw) driver, renting the vehicle to earn daily wages. He is the sole earning member of the family. Her mother, Neha Devi, has studied up to class five and is a homemaker, fully engaged in household responsibilities. The family does not own any agricultural land and survives on the limited income generated by her father. They own only the piece of land on which their house is built. Lado

is the eldest among four siblings, which includes two younger brothers and one sister. None of the children are engaged in any form of work or marriage, they are all dependent on their parents. Despite financial struggles, the family has shown a growing interest in Lado's education, especially after improvements in the local Anganwadi center.

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION

- Lado Kumari, a six-year-old girl from a socially and economically backward family, initially faced several challenges in accessing early childhood education. The Anganwadi Center No. 177, where she was enrolled, was in poor condition, with a broken boundary wall, an unusable toilet, and a dirty surrounding environment. These issues made the center unattractive and uncomfortable, especially for young girls like Lado. As a result, she attended irregularly and showed little interest in learning. Additionally,

her family's low educational background, an illiterate father and a mother educated only up to class five, meant limited support and awareness about the importance of early education at home. Financial instability further restricted the family's ability to invest in educational resources. The lack of a stimulating learning environment and community involvement initially hindered Lado's educational development, making it essential to address these barriers for her holistic growth and sustained engagement in learning.

PROJECT INTERVENTION

- **Tracking of Vulnerability:** Lado was identified as a vulnerable child due to irregular attendance, disinterest in learning, and her family's poor socioeconomic background. She was at risk of educational neglect and malnourishment.

- Issue Identification: The poor condition of the Anganwadi center and Lado's irregular presence were noted by the project staff through regular monitoring and discussions with the center's workers and local collectives.
- Family Intervention: The project team conducted home visits and engaged in counseling sessions with Lado's parents, particularly her mother, to explain the importance of early childhood education and regular attendance.

. Change in Child's Life: With the new TLM and BALA-based environment , Lado's interest in learning grew. She learned the English alphabets, Hindi letters, counting, and began forming words and sentences
 Collective Members' Involvement: Community collective members supported the process by motivating Lado's family and reinforcing the message of child rights and education

. Stakeholder Engagement: Anganwadi workers and local influencers were engaged to support changes at the center and within the community

. Turning Point: The center was renovated using BALA (Building as Learning Aid) techniques with bright wall art , educational illustrations and attractive Teaching Learning Materials (TLM) like toys, charts and puzzles. This significantly improved the learning environment.

. Positive Change in Parents: As the environment improved ,Lado's mother began actively participating in community meetings and personally ensured Lado's regular attendance.

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. Present Situation: Lado is now enrolled in Upgrade Middle School, Raji Shahbazpur, attending regularly and showing good academic progress with her parents' continued support.

OVERALL IMPACT OF THE PROJECT

- The project brought a significant positive change in Lado Kumari's life by transforming both her learning environment and her family's attitude toward education. Initially disinterested and irregular due to the poor condition of the Anganwadi center, Lado was identified as a vulnerable child. Through the

project's timely intervention, the center was renovated with BALA (Building as Learning Aid) techniques and enriched with colorful wall art and engaging Teaching Learning Materials (TLM), making learning fun and interactive. The project team, along with community collectives and stakeholders, counseled her parents and ensured their involvement. This resulted in increased awareness among Lado's mother, who started actively participating and supporting her daughter's education. Lado began attending regularly, showing remarkable improvement in language and numeracy skills. The overall impact is seen in Lado's successful transition to formal schooling in a nearby middle school, symbolizing a shift from vulnerability to opportunity through holistic, community-supported educational reform.